1 Having cut the blanks and sharpened your tools, fix the base blank to your chuck. Mount the base blank to a waste block with hot melt glue on the flat surfaces and then make it perfectly secure by adding a bead of glue around this joint

2 True the outside edge with your bowl gouge and then true up the front face so it is perfectly flat. This surface is going to be the underside of the base and I've chosen to form a recess to suit my chuck jaws. Mark a ring within which this recess will be positioned

3 Turn the recess with either your small bowl gouge or using your 10mm spindle gouge. You can also 'decorate' this recess by inscribing rings cut with the point of a skew

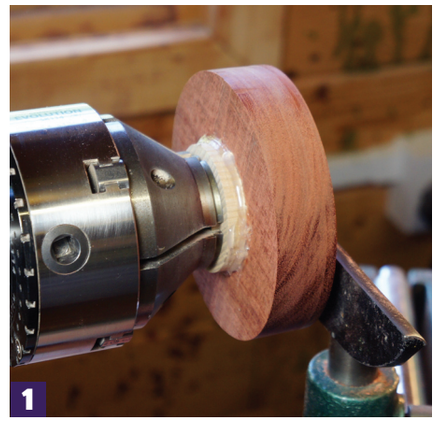
4 Follow the plans and mark the diameter of the base. From this, start to form the OG curve and when complete, finish with a small step. I used my 6mm bowl gouge for the whole process

5 Complete the underside by sanding to 400 grit and apply sanding sealer

6 Reverse the base onto your chuck and turn away the glued waste block. True this side and mark the centre. Move the toolrest up close to the face and level with the centre mark. Scribe a ring 80mm in diameter with either a pencil or the point of a divider. On this ring you will drill two holes exactly 180° apart into which the tenons on the pillars will be inserted. I chose to have the grain orientation running from left to right on the base. Position the face and mark your drill points on the circumference, as shown. Use a centre punch on these points so the drill bit will locate accurately. Take the base to a pillar drill and make two 8mm holes approximately 13mm deep

7 Remount the base in the chuck and finish according to the plans. The central concave shape is outlined by a small bead turned with a fingernail spindle gouge. Use a flat surface like a steel rule, to make sure the finished top surface is perfectly level (otherwise the two pillars won't sit flat). Sand to 400 grit and seal

8 Mount the pillar blank between centres and rough to round. Mark a line 65mm in from the tailstock end. A 5mm hole needs to be drilled through the blank at this point: aesthetically it looks better if the grain is running from left to right across the pillar. To find the drill point, position the tool rest up close to the blank and lock the headstock with the indexing system. Mark a point on the line and then turn the blank 180°, lock again and mark this point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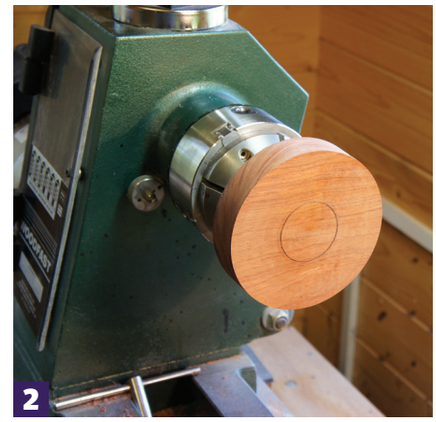
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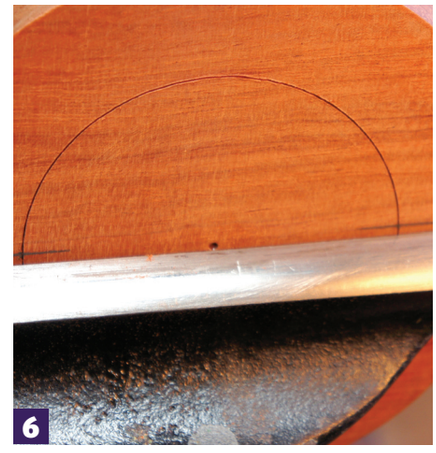
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